

PFTUI Daily Intelligence Report

June 22, 2026

Daily market outlook

By Skylar Simoncelli

Confidential

pftui daily letter

This was the week the market quietly taught a hard lesson about diversification: sometimes you don't own four things, you own one thing wearing four costumes. Bitcoin, gold, and silver all broke down inside the same five trading sessions — and they did it together, falling into a firm, stubborn US dollar that simply refuses to roll over. If you held the "hard money" trio expecting them to zig while everything else zagged, the tape had bad news. They zigged as one. The single most important chart this week wasn't bitcoin, gold, or silver. It was the dollar.

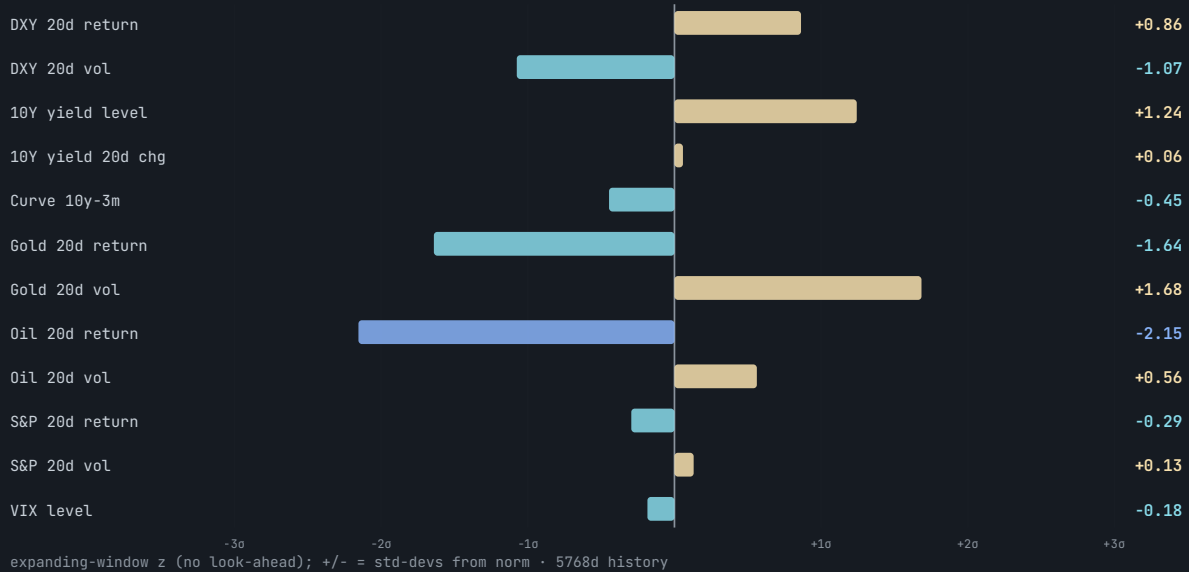
Market Snapshot

ASSET	PRICE	WEEKLY CHANGE
Bitcoin	\$64,643	~ -14%
Gold	\$4,195	-3.1%
Silver	\$65.43	-6.6%
S&P 500	\$7,474	-1.1%
WTI Crude	\$73.58	-8.9%
US Dollar Index (DXY)	101.0	+1.4%
VIX	17.6	+8.5%
10-Year Treasury	4.51%	+0.9%

Macro

Macro Environment – z-scores vs history

as of 2026-06-22



US Real Rates & G10 Differential

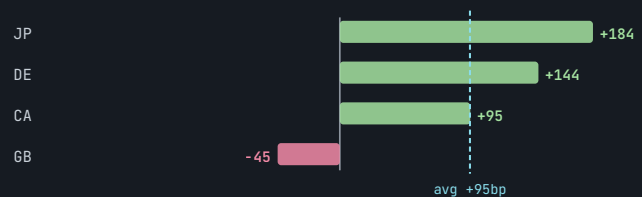
2026-06-17

US 10Y = real (TIPS) + breakeven
nominal 4.49%



real 10Y +2.23% headwind for gold

US 10Y minus G10 partner (bp)



real (TIPS) 10Y is the gold cross-read; US premium pulls the dollar · since 2026-06-15

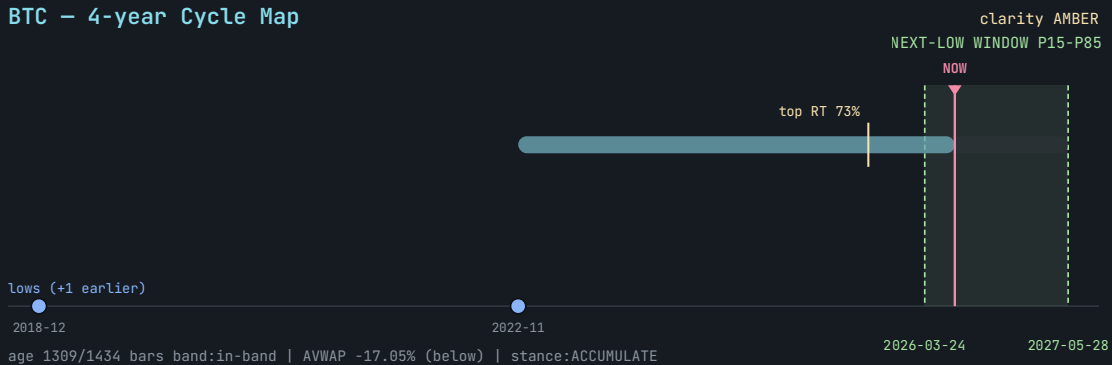
The whole tape right now is one regime: a strong dollar earning a real return. With the dollar index holding above 101 — back over the 100 line it had broken through earlier — and the 10-year Treasury paying north of 2% after inflation, cash and dollars are being paid handsomely to do nothing. That is the gravitational field every other asset is fighting. A bar of gold yields zero. A bitcoin yields zero. When the dollar itself throws off real interest, holding anything that doesn't carries a quiet, compounding opportunity cost — and the market spent this week collecting on it.

Here's the tension worth understanding, because it explains nearly everything else. There are two true stories about the dollar that seem to contradict and don't. The structural story is decline: foreign central banks are buying gold over Treasuries at a pace near 750-850 tonnes a year, the dollar's share of global reserves is grinding toward multi-decade lows, and alternative payment rails keep going live. That's a slow, multi-year erosion. But the cyclical story — the one that governs the next few months — is dollar strength: positive real yields, a wide interest-rate gap over Europe and Japan,

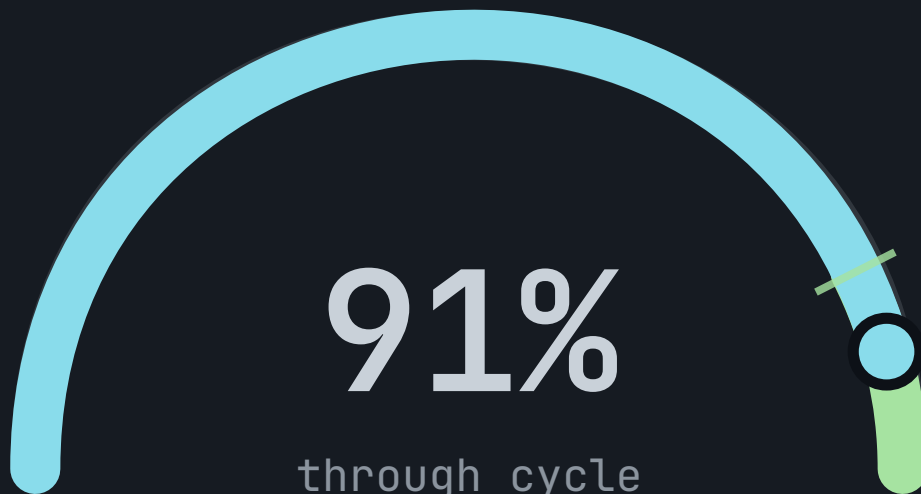
and a Fed that markets currently price as more likely to hike in July than cut. Both are real. The mistake, again and again, is reading the slow secular decline onto a short-term chart and getting run over by the cyclical bid. That's exactly what happened this week.

Bitcoin

BTC - 4-year Cycle Map



BTC 4-YEAR



through cycle
ACCUMULATE

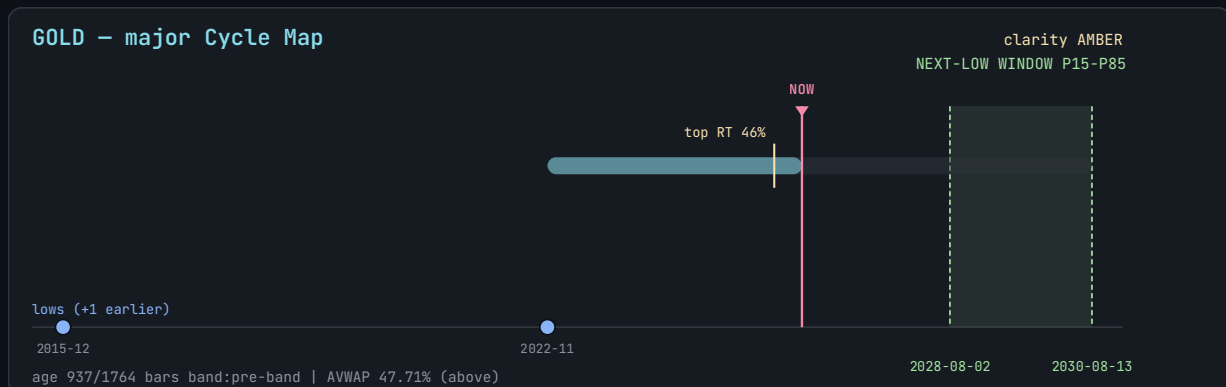
wk 187 of 187-229 band

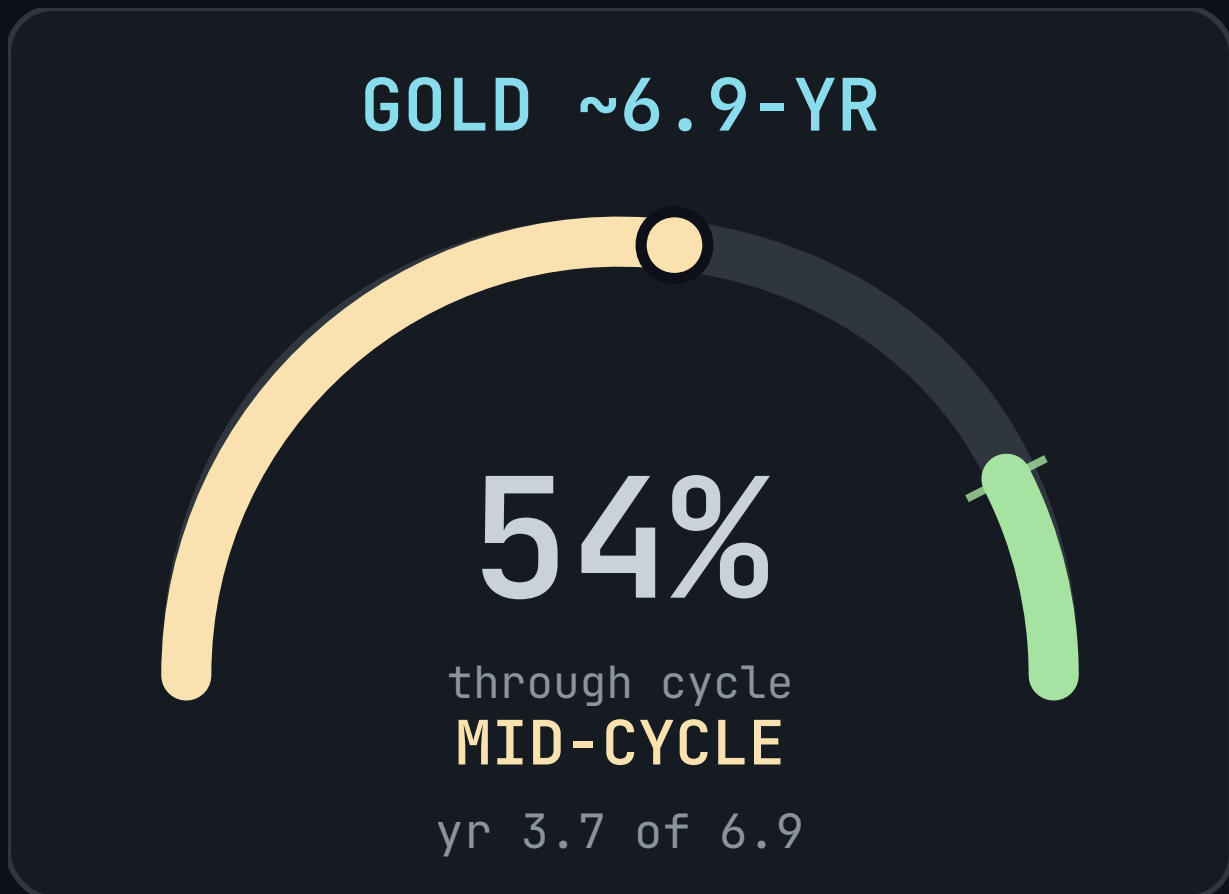
Bitcoin spent the week trading like a leveraged tech stock, not like digital gold — and the correlation math confirms it. Its relationship with the dollar flipped positive, meaning when the dollar caught a bid, bitcoin sold off right alongside risk assets. Crypto sentiment sits at "Extreme Fear," ETF flows have turned to net outflows of roughly a

thousand coins a day, and price broke a key weekly support level near \$65,955 in early June and hasn't reclaimed it. The crowded leverage that built up into late May has been getting flushed, and that flush may not be finished.

And yet bitcoin is the one asset in this group with a genuinely interesting story underneath the ugly tape. By the long-cycle clock that has roughly governed bitcoin's four-year rhythm, it now sits inside the accumulation band — the cold, unloved stretch where, historically, forward returns have been strongest precisely because nobody wants it. Several independent timing frameworks cluster a potential cycle low around October. That doesn't mean "buy now." Being in the accumulation band is not the same as the bottom being in; the season is right, but the tape is still pointing down. The honest read is patience: this is a process to engage on confirmation — a daily reclaim above roughly \$66,290, then a weekly close back above \$65,955 with ETF flows turning positive — not a calendar date to front-run. A daily close below \$60,000 would say the capitulation leg is still ahead.

Gold (and Precious Metals)





Gold fell about 3% on the week, breaking its own weekly support near \$4,480 and slipping below its short-term moving averages. But context matters enormously here, and it's the opposite of bitcoin's. Gold is not at a cycle low — it's roughly mid-cycle, only about three and a half years into a rhythm that historically runs closer to seven, and it's still trading well above the average price paid by buyers since its last major bottom. Its longer-term trend line is still rising. What we saw this week was a pullback inside an uptrend, not the start of a collapse — and certainly not a discount-bin bottom to back up the truck for. The single biggest error available right now is treating this dip as a buy toward some deeper low; the structure simply doesn't support that read.

Silver took the same blow and amplified it, down nearly 7% — the worst performer in the group. That's silver being silver: it carries gold's monetary story plus an industrial demand story (solar, grid, AI-power buildout), and that higher beta cuts both ways. With oil cratering nearly 9% on the week — a loud signal that someone is worried about demand — silver's industrial leg took a second hit. The tell to watch is gold: silver doesn't get its own bottom, it gets gold's. A gold reclaim back above its key levels while the dollar finally rolls over is the single thing that would flip silver higher. Until then, it's a knife, not a bargain.

Equities

Stocks were the quiet outlier. The S&P 500 slipped only about 1% and is still riding above its major moving averages near record territory — a striking divergence from a week in which bitcoin fell 14% and the metals broke down. Volatility ticked up but stayed remarkably calm; the VIX near 17 is the dog that didn't bark through a genuine crypto rout. The one crack worth noting is in AI and semiconductors, where a soft guide from a major chipmaker hit the group hard. That's not broad risk-off — it's an early de-rating of the richest corner of the market, the kind of single-name air pocket that can either stay contained or quietly spread. For now, the equity tape is doing its own thing while the hard-money complex bleeds.

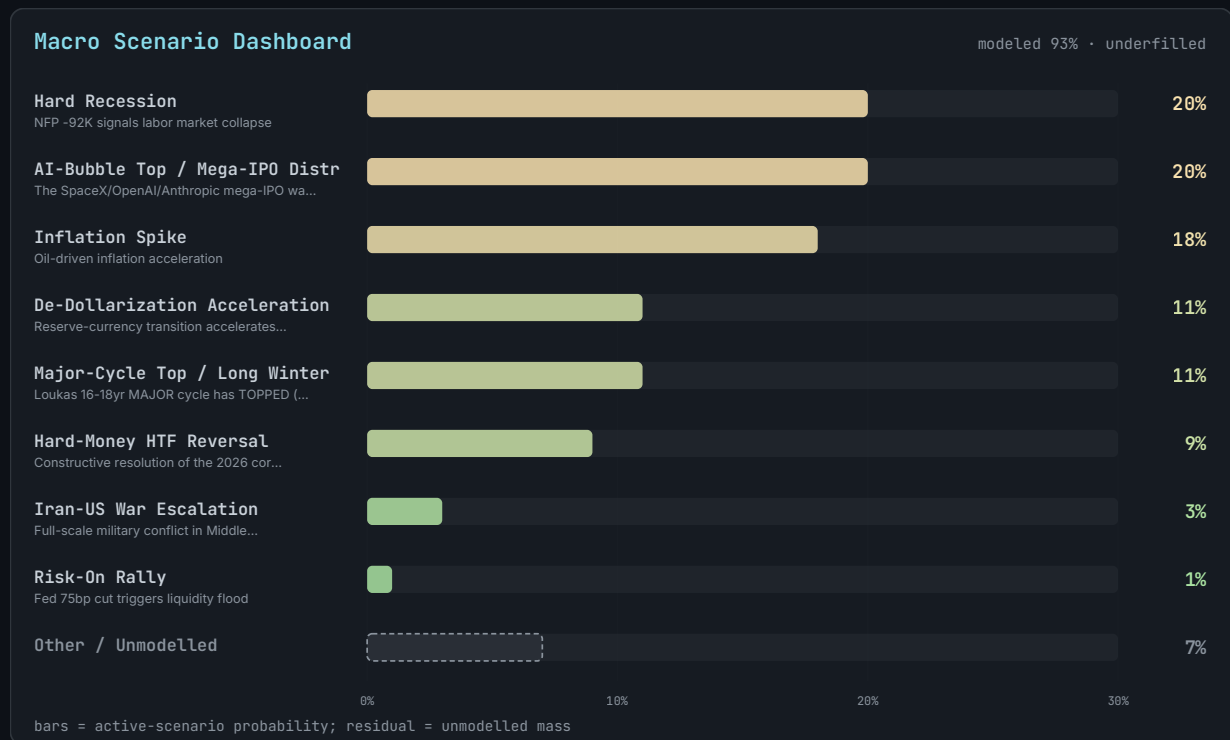
News & Catalysts



The next two weeks decide which dollar story wins. Watch, in order:

- **Core PCE inflation (June 25)** — the Fed's preferred inflation gauge. A hot print keeps the Fed restrictive and the dollar firm; a cool one is the first crack in the cyclical bid.
- **The July 29 Fed meeting** — currently priced with real odds of a hike and essentially none of a cut. A hawkish hold keeps the gate shut on every hard-money asset.
- **Oil** — down 9% this week. Continued weakness reads as demand destruction, which pressures silver's industrial leg and raises recession risk.
- **Mid-July reserve data** — the next read on whether central banks are still rotating out of dollars and into gold, the fundamental floor under the metals thesis.

Scenario Dashboard



Two scenarios dominate from here, and a single variable tips both. The hopeful one — a hard-money reversal where gold, silver, and bitcoin re-rate higher together — only unlocks if the dollar finally breaks down, meaning a weekly close below roughly 98.8 with falling real yields. The other, quieter risk is that inflation re-accelerates, forcing the Fed to stay tight and pushing the dollar higher — which would extend this entire pullback toward 2027. The catalyst that tips the balance is the same one everything else hinges on: the dollar's reaction to the inflation data and the July Fed meeting. Watch the dollar, and you'll know which way the basket breaks before the basket does.

The Bottom Line

The takeaway this week isn't "buy the dip" — it's something more useful. The hard-money complex is down because the dollar is up, the dollar is up for specific, dated, observable reasons, and the reversal everyone's waiting for is a process gated on a hinge, not a feeling and not a calendar. Bitcoin has the most compelling setup of the four, but even there the move is to wait for confirmation rather than to catch a falling knife. Cash isn't idleness in this regime — it's the one position that gets paid to wait for the dollar to turn. When the hinge moves, you'll see it on one chart. Watch that chart.

This letter is general market commentary, not investment advice. Do your own research.

